

How to read an academic paper?

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Agenda

1. reader's recipe
2. reading objectives
3. reading techniques
4. scientific language
5. reading notes



Reader's recipe

1.

Define your purpose of
reading

2.

Familiarize yourself
with the topic

3.

Develop an individual
system for taking notes



Reading objectives

- Prepare for discussion in the seminar
 - Gain an overview of the topic
 - Check whether the text fits the topic
 - Critical examination of the text
 - Extract specific information from the text
 - Fun and entertainment
- **Reading speed and thoroughness should be adapted to the goal**
- 

Reading techniques

Handout at mystudy

Filtering (un)important informations !

- make the task completely clear to oneself
- Formulate questions about the text

Skimming – orientational reading

- to get an overview

Scanning

- to check whether the text fits the topic/goal

Thorough reading

- read and understand completely

Selective reading

- passages that are necessary for the selected topic

Analytical reading

- Examine text for specific aspects

Complex reading method: PQ4R

- Preview, question, read, reflect, recite and review

Understanding scientific language

- Translation of scientific language into everyday language
 - Rephrasing ensures better understanding
- Scientific language precisely names phenomena using technical terms:
 - Look up technical terms in dictionaries, deduce meaning from context
 - Look up (real life) examples and applications
- Acquire vocabulary by means of lists and index cards with technical terms and definitions in your own words

Understanding scientific language

- Break down long sentences for better understanding:
 - Unpacking sentences in statements
 - How do the statements relate to each other?

After practising several times, it will become easier to break down sentences in your head and understand them better

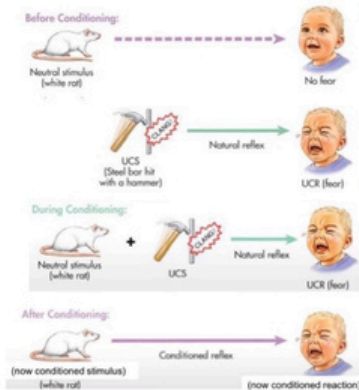
A large purple semi-circle is positioned in the top-left corner of the slide. A dark green, organic-shaped graphic is located in the bottom-right corner.

Reading notes

- Summarize the text's structure and main ideas
- Use visual tools to help process the content
 - Underlining, colors, arrows, boxes
- Possible formats: depending on text and topic
 - Mind map
 - Concept Map
 - Organisational chart

Examples

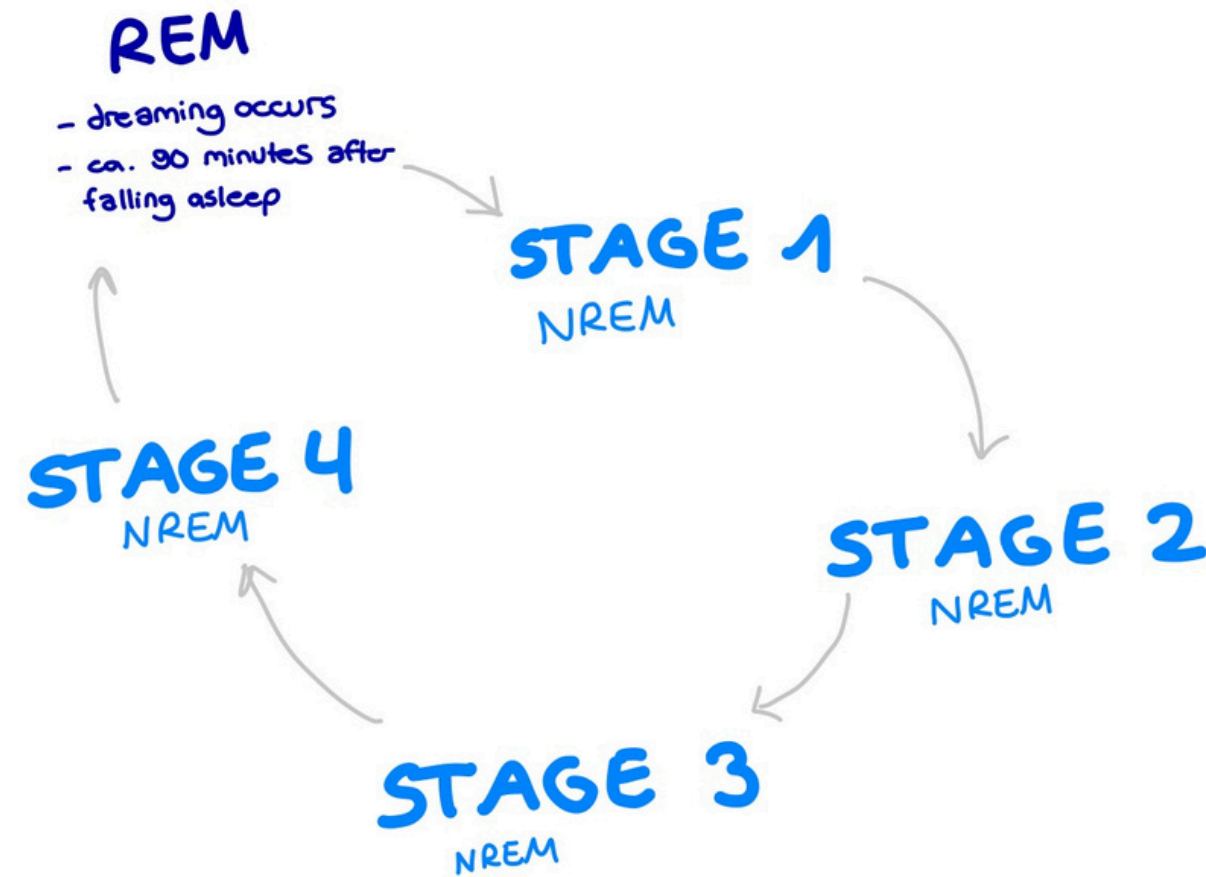
Reading 10: Little Emotional Albert, J.B. Watson 1920

Zeitgeist	research aim / theoretical propositions	research design / IV + DV / moderator					
→ New rising School of thought : Behaviorism (mechanistic view) ↳ focused only on what could be seen, heard or touched → observable behavioral acts <table><tr><th>behaviorism</th><th>psychoanalysis</th></tr><tr><td> - Watson = founding father of Behaviorism - methods : <u>observation</u>, verbal report, conditioning - sensory + perceptual + cognitive processes are ignored → intrapsychic processes = "black box" </td><td> - unconscious intrapsychic conflicts = drivers of behavior, emotions, thoughts - human behavior = based on ideas that we are motivated by unconscious instincts + repressed emotions from early childhood </td></tr></table>	behaviorism	psychoanalysis	- Watson = founding father of Behaviorism - methods : <u>observation</u>, verbal report, conditioning - sensory + perceptual + cognitive processes are ignored → intrapsychic processes = "black box"	- unconscious intrapsychic conflicts = drivers of behavior, emotions, thoughts - human behavior = based on ideas that we are motivated by unconscious instincts + repressed emotions from early childhood	demonstrate that all human behavior stems from learning and conditioning (b) demonstrate that the Freudian conception of human nature, that our behavior stems from unconscious processes, was wrong	- participant : "Albert" → 9 months old , physically + emotionally healthy → also presented with "looking similar to a rat objects", e.g. a rabbit DV : fear reaction - no clearly defined IV (no compared conditions, no control condition) ↳ no experimental manipulation!!! Confounders not controlled!!! → CASE STUDY ↳ WE are not allowed to make inferences about any kind of population 	
behaviorism	psychoanalysis						
- Watson = founding father of Behaviorism - methods : <u>observation</u>, verbal report, conditioning - sensory + perceptual + cognitive processes are ignored → intrapsychic processes = "black box"	- unconscious intrapsychic conflicts = drivers of behavior, emotions, thoughts - human behavior = based on ideas that we are motivated by unconscious instincts + repressed emotions from early childhood						
results / important findings	definitions / important terms	criticism					
The emotional response to unconditioned stimuli could be transferred to neutral stimuli. Therefore, they become conditioned stimuli. These reactions occur also with objects similar to the conditioned stimuli and in other situations.	Classical conditioning (Pavlov): An unconditioned stimulus (US) which leads to a unconditioned response (UR) is paired with a neural stimulus (NS) <i>struck hammer</i> US → UR <i>food</i> <i>crying / fear</i> <i>salivating</i> conditioning: <i>struck hammer</i> <i>food</i> US paired with NS <i>rat</i> <i>bell ring</i> Through repetition, the neutral stimulus (NS) eventually will become an conditioned stimulus (CS) & will be associated with the now conditioned response (CR) <i>over time</i> : NS becomes a CS <i>bell ringing</i> CS → CR <i>salivating</i> -> pairing of stimulus + emotion is now conditioned <i>Pavlov</i> <i>Watson</i>	-research design - no control of any confounding variables - external validity = not given ↳ case study - low content validity ↳ DV based on subjective personal observations -violation of ethical standards in research - no informed consent (participant was a baby!!) - no right to withdraw - questionable motivation behind study (→ attacking psychoanalysis) - Watson profited from precarious situation of mother (mother = nurse, was paid) - intervention in fact did harm the child ↳ discomfort + fear during experiment ↳ potential life-long negative effects → no reconditioning					
Learning and conditioning ->		importance for psychology / society / recent applications					

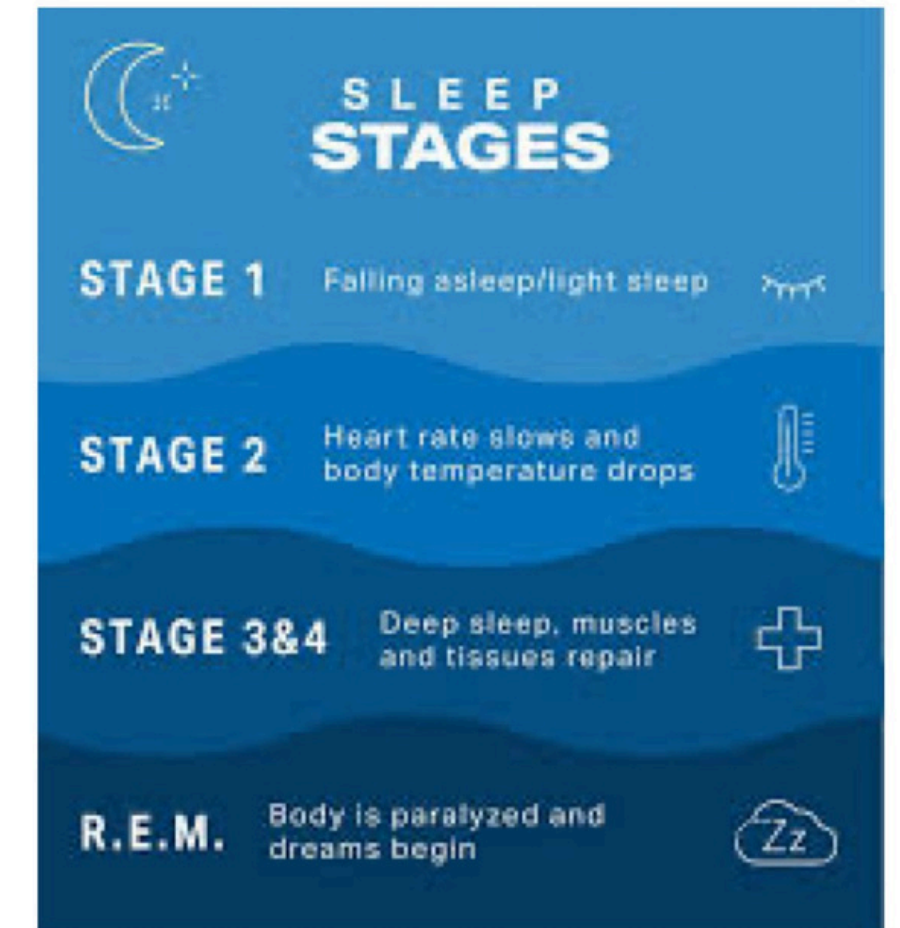
important: just a possible approach, not a perfect guideline

Examples

Four stages of sleep



- repeats five-six times during the night
- NREM becoming shorter, REM longer
- EVERYONE dreams



important: just a possible approach, not a perfect guideline

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Thank you!

You can find all materials at [mystudy](#).